

LITTLE LAB COATS • PRINTABLE STEM GUIDE

5 STEM Play Ideas for Kindergarten

Five playful, parent-friendly activities that feel fun first and educational second.



How to use this: Pick one activity, gather simple supplies, and keep it light. The goal is to entertain your child, spark curiosity, and sneak in great observation and language practice along the way.

1. Pom-Pom Tube Drop

NEED: TOILET PAPER TUBES, TAPE, POM-POMS

Try it: Tape cardboard tubes to a wall or big box and drop pom-poms through to make a little maze.

- Try straight paths and twisty paths.
- See which route makes the pom-pom move fastest.
- Let your child redesign it and test again.

2. Sink-or-Float Treasure Tub

NEED: BOWL OF WATER, TOWEL, HOUSEHOLD OBJECTS

Try it: Gather a few safe items like a spoon, cork, leaf, block, coin, or pom-pom. Guess first, then test.

- Let your child sort items into sink and float.
- Talk about which ones were surprising.
- Repeat with new objects another day.

3. Magnet Treasure Hunt

NEED: MAGNET, BASKET OF SAFE OBJECTS

Try it: Search for things the magnet can pick up. Make a yes pile and a no pile.

- Test keys, paper clips, foil, fabric, toy cars, and spoons.
- Ask what the “yes” items have in common.

4. Leaf Detective Walk

NEED: OUTDOOR SPACE, LEAVES, MAGNIFYING GLASS IF YOU HAVE ONE

Try it: Collect a few leaves and compare size, shape, color, and texture.

- Line them up from smallest to biggest.
- Notice smooth edges vs. jagged edges.
- Let your child choose a favorite and explain why.

5. Balloon Rocket Race

NEED: STRING, STRAW, TAPE, BALLOON

Try it: Thread string through a straw, tape a balloon to the straw, blow it up, and let it zoom across the room.

- Race two balloons if you want extra excitement.
- See which one travels farther.
- Talk about how the escaping air makes it move.

Little Lab Coats • Kindergarten STEM that feels playful, visual, and actually doable at home